Bricks are laid along and across the stock in alternate layers. The drying of brick is done by the following means:

a. **Artificial Drying:** Drying by tunnels usually 120°c about 1 to 3 days.
b. **Circulation of Air:** Stacks are arranged in such a way that sufficient space is left between them for free circulation of air.
c. **Drying Yard**: Special yards should be prepared slightly higher level to prevent the accumulation of rain water.



d. **Period of Drying :** Usually three to ten days for bricks to dry.

3.2.5.4. Burning

This is very important operation in the manufacture of bricks. It imparts hardness and strength to brick and makes them dense and durable. The bricks should be burnt properly.

If bricks are over burnt, they will be brittle and hence break easily. If they are under burnt, they will be soft and cannot carry loads.

During burning, when the temperature of about 650°c is attained, the organic matter contained in the brick is oxidized and also the water of crystallization is driven away.

When the temperature of about 1100°c is reached, the particles of the earth bind themselves together resulting in the increase of strength and density to bricks. Further heating is not desirable and if the temperature is raised beyond 1100°c great amount of fusible glassy mass is formed and the bricks lots its shape.

Bricks are burnt in clamps or kilns.



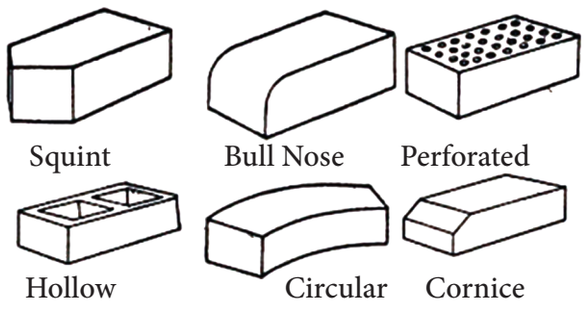
Clamp

3.2.6 Classification of Brick

According to use, bricks are classified into five categories.

They are,

i) Ordinary Bricks
ii) Engineering Bricks (special bricks for carrying heavy loads)
iii) Facing Bricks
iv) Fire Bricks
v) Special bricks (special shapes)



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